

What shipped in the September 2026 batch

Six things the union asked for, what each one does, how it works underneath, who is responsible for it, and what to watch out for. Short on purpose.

THE ONE FLOW WORTH MEMORISING



Who this is for

Union administrators, club chairpersons and the platform team. Each part says who it is for. No technical knowledge assumed until Part Four.

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PART ONE

At a glance

The Dolphins (KZNCU) office raised six issues in September. Five are built and reviewed. One is deliberately on hold. Every fix works for every union on the platform, not just Dolphins.

ISSUE RAISED	WHAT WE FOUND	WHAT SHIPPED	WHERE
Clubs with two sides in one league can't tell which side a fixture belongs to	True. The fixtures table only showed the opponent.	A Side column, "playing as" on each series card, and the side named in the next-match banner and in the fixtures message sent to players.	Club portal → Fixtures
Insights shows 0 clubs for Veterans Premier and Veterans Promotion	The fixtures were imported from the union's spreadsheet, but no club was ever marked as entered in those leagues.	A sync tool that marks clubs as entered from the fixtures they appear in. The importer now does this itself. Insights flags any league that has fixtures but no entrants.	Platform team tool + Admin → Insights
Dawnheights wants to enter U11 and U13 in the EMCU	EMCU is a district inside the Dolphins union, not a separate client. The junior leagues exist, but a club from another district could not see them.	Admins can enter a club into leagues from other districts. The club's own form shows those as "entered by the union" and never drops them.	Admin → Clubs → Leagues
Move the 12/13 December fixtures to 16/17 January	Confirmed: only Premier Men 50-Over and Veterans Promotion play that weekend. Veterans Promotion already plays on 16 January, so later rounds must shuffle.	On hold while the union decides. A preview-only tool shows the resulting calendar.	Platform team tool
Saints Cricket Club has a new chairperson	Already self-serve. One gap: the old chair's ID number and term dates carried over to the new name.	Fixed. A name change now clears the previous person's details.	Admin → Clubs → Edit chairperson
Veterans sides want to pick players from any club	No way to do it. The only building block was a player's own declaration that they play veterans for another club.	A find-and-request flow. The player's own club must accept. Admins can override.	Club portal → Veterans squad; Admin → Veterans Requests
Export only gives league totals ("34 clubs, 219 teams")	True. The League breakdown sheet had counts only.	Two new sheets, Teams by league and Clubs by league , list every club and side per division.	Admin → Insights → Export Excel

PART TWO

Club portal

For club chairpersons and representatives. Three things look different.

Fixtures now say which of your sides is playing

Open **Fixtures**. Each series card ends with *playing as Saints Cricket Club B* (one side) or *your sides: A, B, C* (several). When you field two or more sides in the same series, the table gains a **Side** column. A derby between your own sides appears once, with the home side in **Side** and the away side under **Opponent**.

WHY IT WAS MISSING

A fixture stores two team identifiers, not names. Each series carries a snapshot mapping identifiers to clubs and side names. The portal always had the mapping; it simply never printed your own side.

Veterans squad: find a player, ask their club

A **Veterans squad** item appears in the left menu only for clubs the union has fixtured into a veterans league. Nobody is added to your squad without their own club agreeing.

1

Find

Type at least three letters of a name into **Find a player**. You see the player's name and their club, nothing else. Players already affiliated to a veterans club, already registered in a veterans league, or your own players, do not appear.

2

Request

Click **Request**, optionally with a short note. The row flips to **Requested** and the request appears under **Pending requests**, where you can withdraw it. The other club's chairperson gets an email.

3

The other club decides

On their **Players** page a card reads *Crusaders CC asks to register Thabo Ndlovu for veterans cricket*, with **Accept** and **Decline**. The player's roster row shows a **Veterans request** pill until they act.

4

Done

On accept the player appears in your **Veterans affiliates** list and under **Recent outcomes**. The player stays on their own club's roster. Your roster count does not change.

WHAT ACCEPT DOES NOT DO

It does not move the player, change either club's player count, or start a clearance. It records that this person plays veterans cricket for your club, the same record a player creates when they declare it at registration.

Leagues the union entered for you

If an administrator enters your club into a league outside your district (an EMCU junior league for an Ilembe club, for example), step three of your affiliation form shows it under **Entered by the union**. You cannot untick it, and re-saving the form or changing your district will not drop it. Only the union office can remove it.

PART THREE

Admin console

For union administrators. Four screens changed.

Entering a club into another district's league

Clubs → the club → **Leagues**. Below the district's own chips is a collapsed **Leagues from other districts (N)**. Expand it, tick the leagues, **Save leagues**. Selected cross-district leagues stay visible with their district as a suffix even when the section is collapsed.

DAWNHEIGHTS

Clubs → Dawnheights Cricket Club → Leagues → expand → tick **Under 11** and **Under 13** under Ethekwini Metro Cricket Union → Save. One side each is the default.

Veterans Requests

A new **Veterans Requests** menu item with a pending count. It lists every request in the union with filters for pending, accepted, declined and withdrawn. Clubs normally resolve these themselves; use **Accept** or **Decline** here only as a union override. A decline asks for an optional reason, which the requesting club sees. Overrides are recorded as such and both chairpersons are emailed.

Insights and the export

Per-league counts are unchanged in how they work: they count clubs that are *entered* in a league, not clubs that happen to have fixtures. A league with fixtures but no entrants now shows a small note asking you to have the platform team run the club league sync. **Export Excel** gains **Teams by league** (one row per side, with club, district and chair contact) and **Clubs by league** (one row per club per league, with the number of sides and their names).

Changing a chairperson

Clubs → the club → **Edit chairperson**. Enter the new name, email and cell. When the name differs from the current chair, a note tells you the previous person's ID number and term dates will be cleared; the club re-enters them on its affiliation form. Notices such as clearance alerts route to the new contact immediately.

THIS DOES NOT CHANGE WHO CAN LOG IN

Portal access is separate. Go to **Team & Access**, invite the new chair as a representative of the club, and remove or narrow the previous person's access.

PART FOUR

Platform team

Two command-line tools and one secret. Both tools preview by default and write nothing without `--confirm`.

Club league sync

Reads every released series, works out which clubs appear in which league, and marks those clubs as entered (with the right number of sides and their names). It only ever adds; it never removes a league, and it skips a club whose stored side names disagree with the fixtures rather than overwrite them. Safe to run twice.

```
npx sst shell --stage prod -- npx tsx packages/api/src/sync-club-leagues-from-series.ts dolphins
npx sst shell --stage prod -- npx tsx packages/api/src/sync-club-leagues-from-series.ts dolphins --confirm
```

Expected on Dolphins: about 26 clubs patched; Insights then shows 12 clubs in Veterans Premier and 15 in Veterans Promotion. The fixtures importer now runs this automatically after every import, in both its modes, so the zero should not recur.

Shift fixture dates (on hold)

Moves every fixture on one date to another and cascades later rounds so nothing collides. The default cascade takes the next existing playing date, so planned gaps such as Easter are kept. It prints a round-by-round table and refuses to write if the move would introduce a ground clash. Use the preview to show the union what the calendar would become.

```
npx sst shell --stage prod -- npm --prefix packages/api run shift-fixture-dates -- \
  --tenant dolphins \
  --series s-planb-premier-men-50ov-top6,s-planb-premier-men-50ov-bottom6,\
  s-planb-veterans-promotion-30ov \
  --from-date 2026-12-12,2026-12-13 --to-date 2027-01-16,2027-01-17
```

DO NOT ADD --CONFIRM

The client is still deciding. Nothing in the platform notifies clubs when fixture dates change, so any real move needs a communication plan alongside it.

One new secret before deploying

The veterans finder never sends a player's identity key to another club. It sends an opaque handle derived from a server secret. That secret must exist on each stage or the finder fails closed with an error:

```
sst secret set CandidateHandleSecret $(openssl rand -hex 32) --stage dev
sst secret set CandidateHandleSecret $(openssl rand -hex 32) --stage prod
```

Order of operations: merge and push, set the secret, deploy dev, run the sync on dev, check Insights, then prod.

PART FIVE

Who is responsible for what

TASK	ROLE	NOTES
Request a player for a veterans side	Veterans club chair or rep	Only clubs fixtured in a veterans league see the menu item.
Accept or decline a veterans request	The player's own club chair or rep	The club is the responsible party for its players' data. It decides.
Override a stuck request	Union administrator	Recorded as a union override; both chairs emailed. Use sparingly.
Enter a club into another district's league	Union administrator	Clubs cannot do this themselves and cannot undo it.
Change a club's chairperson	Union administrator	Then swap portal access under Team & Access.
Run the club league sync	Platform team	Dry-run, read the output, then confirm. Per stage.
Move fixture dates in bulk	Platform team, on the union's written instruction	Preview only until the client decides. Plan the club communication.
Set the candidate-handle secret	Platform team	Once per stage, before the deploy that carries this batch.
Read fixtures with your side shown	Everyone at the club	No action needed.

Implications and gotchas

Privacy

The finder is the first screen where one club sees another club's players. It shows a name and a club, nothing more. No ID numbers, contact details or dates of birth leave the server, and every search is logged. A club can only search once the union has actually fixtured it into a veterans league; ticking the league on its own form is not enough.

Nothing moves

Accepting a veterans request is a note on the player's record, not a transfer. Player counts, demographics and clearances are untouched. If a player later transfers clubs, the affiliation follows the existing transfer rules.

Notifications are email only

Request, accept and decline emails go to the club chairperson on record. A club with no chair email simply gets no email; the request still appears in the portal. There are no WhatsApp messages for this feature.

Counts follow entries, not fixtures

Insights and the new export sheets count clubs that are entered in a league. Until the sync runs on prod, the two veterans leagues will still read zero and their divisions will be empty in the export. Every other league already populates.

Clubs crossing from one league to two

Player demographics attribute a player with no recorded league to their club's only league. A club that gains a second league through the sync loses that shortcut, so the "unattributed" figure can rise. This is the honest number, not a regression.

The December move is not done

Only Premier Men 50-Over (both halves) and Veterans Promotion 30-Over play on 12 and 13 December. Veterans Promotion already plays on 16 January, so its later rounds must each move one slot. Premier Men has 17 January free. Nothing changes until the union confirms, and there is no automatic notice to clubs when it does.